196 Droman
Guest Information

Nr Kinlochbervie, Sutherland, IV27 4RU

Welcome to 196 Droman. Here are some notes which we hope are useful during your time here. The cottage is primarily a family holiday home - very comfortable and well loved, but slightly faded around the edges!

ON ARRIVAL

When you first arrive, go into the kitchen and to the left of the kitchen sink, below the clock, you'll see a standard hot water and heating control panel. Turn this on as you require - instructions for operation are inside the flip down cover on the wall control panel.

IMMERSION HEATER

If you need hot water swiftly, there is an immersion heater switch in the kitchen to the right of the sink behind the bread maker. Please use this minimally and switch it off as soon as you have the hot water you need. Because it's tucked away it is easy to forget.

ACCOMMODATION

The bedroom configuration is as follows:

- Bedroom 1 King-sized bed
- Bedroom 2 Two singles which can be joined together with big blanket and king sized sheet to make a good sized double bed- under the beds are there are two additional mattresses and one temporary put-me-up bed which can be set up in Bedroom 3
- Bedroom 3 Called the Day Room, this large room has a king-sized bed and space for additional mattresses/collapsable bed currently in Bedroom 2

BEDDING

The airing cupboard at the top of the stairs has pillows, duvets, etc. There are:

- 2 x king size duvets
- 2 x double duvet
- 4 x single duvets
- Lots of blankets
- Beach towels, tea towels and hand towels - feel free to use but wash and replace before you leave

HOWEVER whilst we don't have a cleaner unfortunately it's hard for guests to use these and get them washed and dried before they leave so we advise guests bringing their own. if it is very difficult for you to bring your own (eg because of luggage allowances) then let us know prior to your trip.

FUEL FOR OPEN FIRE

There should be kindling, fire lighters, and fuel for the open fire in the living room. Coal and further stocks of fuel including peat are in the workshop. Rather than asking you to restock the coal you use at the end of your stay, please could you contribute to the honesty box (on shelf in living room, suggest £2 per fire). If you need more kindling it can be bought from the local shop or garage at Kinlochbervie.

Living room

THE LOG

Since my parents first bought the cottage, visitors have contributed to 'The Log', a diary of their stay written both as a record of experiences and also as entertainment for future guests. It lives on the shelf to the left of the fire - do continue the tradition if you wish (it's not compulsory!)

MAPS
There are plenty of maps of the area and beyond - feel free to use.

BASIC FOOD ETC SUPPLIES
There should be a small supply of the basics on your arrival - tea, sugar, coffee, herbs and spices etc but to be on the safe side you'd best bring what you need for your holiday catering. You are welcome to use anything in the cupboards (but check the sell by dates!). Bread can sometimes be a bit tricky to come by, so please feel free to use the bread maker (instructions inside the machine). There is a cafeterie and also an AeroPress coffee maker. There will be washing up liquid and cleaning materials.

KITCHEN
The cupboards etc should supply all crockery, glasses etc you'll need but there are extra of pretty much everything in the large cupboard by the freezer in the workshop, plus slow cooker and paella dish!

LOCAL SHOPS
The nearest food shop is in Kinlochbervie - follow the road down towards the harbour and turn right after the church. The London Stores, another option, is by the side of the road towards Rhiconich. You can also order your shopping online via Tescos and it's delivered to the car park at the Kinlochbervie Hotel and they are there most days. Not good for local economy but very useful. The nearest very large supermarkets are in Inverness, but there is a good sized Tescos in Ullapool.

For fishing tackle and other very useful supplies, the Chandlers in KLB harbour is excellent. KLB garage, back on the main road, has lots of household supplies and also houses the Post Office.

KAYAKS
The barn and the byre is an additional building which belongs to 196 Droman. The key to the padlock for the Barn is hanging up behind the back door. The Barn and Byre is located just past the cottage, as you turn right it's on your left behind the house with the conservatory. There are two sea kayaks in there - please feel free to use them as you wish, **but be careful to consider the ability of the user as well as the local conditions, which can change rapidly. The seas off Droman can be trecherous and if you take these out you do so entirely at your own risk.** There are lifejackets in the workshop which must be worn if kayaks are taken out. To prevent damage, these kayaks must not be dragged along the road to / from the pier – please carry or use a vehicle to transport them. Please ensure the kayaks are left stored on their sides and the paddles are stored in the barn with the kayaks.

Finally, if you see any damage or faults with the kayaks, please do what you can to repair them yourself but let us know.

DUSTBINS
There are 3 of these and the refuse collectors are very particular about correct rubbish in correct bin! Please study the labelling on the various wheelie bins and use accordingly. Also the collection times are a bit complicated so please check **https://highland-self.achieveservice.com/en/service/Check_your_household_bin_collection_days.** Bins need to be wheeled out to the side of the house near the road.

CONNECTIVITY
The new mobile phone tower at Blairmore now showers the cottage with a strong 4G signal. The primary network provider is EE, but others may join in due course. If you are with EE you should get a good mobile and 4G internet signal in the cottage and general environs. If not, you might struggle but we have installed an 4G WiFi router, which provides a reasonably fast (35-95mbps) internet connection and WiFI calling. There are two WiFi networks - 4GEE_Router_6546_2.4GHz and 4GEE_Router_6546_5GHz - You can use either and the WiFi key is the same for both: kr3ny37DWCeA.

We have allocated 20gb of data per week, but if you run out and need more simply text 07779 304 921 and we can organise that for you. If you know that you will definitely need more than this (i.e. for a day long Zoom or MS Teams call or if you are planning to watch The Godfather trilogy everyday in 4K), let us know ahead of time and you can buy extra data easily.

There is no landline at 196 but you should be able to use you mobile phone for calls, if you enable the

WiFi calling option on your phone. We haven't tested this as we are both on EE, but are assured that it will work! We have an unlimited call package so feel free to use it for calls as much as you like.This is a new system for the cottage, so please do give us feedback if it doesn't work for any reason.

WORKSHOP

The key for the workshop hangs behind the back door. You are welcome to use any items in the workshop, as long as they are replaced in the state they were found. There are a few wetsuits of various sizes - if you use them rinse them in fresh water and leave to drip-dry in the back-passage before returning them, dry-ish, to the workshop for hanging-up and further drying.

The freezer, washing machine, dryer and overflow fridge are all in the workshop. There is also some sea-angling equipment, body-boards, buckets and spades, crabbing lines, barbeque grills etc etc. The **freezer stays switched on** but if you use fridge etc please switch off at the end of your stay.

WASHING LINE

The washing line opposite the croft belongs to us - pegs are in the workshop. The croft has washing machine and dryer, and a good airing cupboard. Outdoor coats and boots etc can be dried in the downstairs loo.

NEIGHBOURS/THE COMMUNITY

The small settlement of Droman is a very friendly community. George (Fulton, 01971 521 227) lives in the house set back and facing the sea, and will be more than happy to answer any questions/have a chat; he looks after the cottage while it's empty.

KINLOCHBERVIE HEALTH CENTRE

01971 521 260

IF ANY QUESTIONS OR PROBLEMS AT ALL:

Call Anne on 07815 794 590 or Murray on 07779 304 921

CHECKLIST ON DEPARTURE:

- Please turn the electric shower off with the pull cord
- Restock the kindling basket and coal skuttles for next guest
- We ask that you don't leave food in the fridge/freezer or the cupboards when you leave as it usually will have to be thrown away. Switch off kitchen fridge unless you've been asked to keep it on, and leave open
- Please leave freezer in workshop ON
- The overflow fridge in workshop should be switched OFF
- We ask that you put duvets and pillows back in the airing cupboard
- As we unfortunately don't have a cleaner at the moment, please leave 196 Droman in the state in which you found it, including the oven and fridge; hoover and cleaning materials under the stairs, mop and bucket in the workshop
- VERY IMPORTANT please double check that the Immersion switch is off and the central heating and hot water control panel is set and displays as **OFF** on both water and heating
- Then please lock up workshop and cottage and replace the key in the key safe
- We hope you've had a lovely time, and thank you for staying in our cottage

Droman Bay

Kite flying, Polin Beach

Balnakeil Beach

Droman Bay

ACTIVITIES AND EXCURSIONS

LOCAL BEACHES

Our local beach is called **Polin** - the easiest way of getting to it is by walking down the road to the pier and then following the path and fence up the hill to the left. Cross over the stile at the top of the hill, following the path which follows the hillside above the bay and then curves down onto the beach. (Or you can cross over the croft in front of the house and follow the path through the sand dunes).

Droman bay is just at the end of the road, a charming rocky cove.

Oldshoremore Beach, the next bay along in a southerly direction, can be reached either by walking around the headland from Polin (with care), or via the road. **Sheigra Beach**, the next one to the north, likewise, can be walked to either around the headland (take care of the cliffs), or via the road.

Sandwood Bay is a hugely popular destination for tourists in the area as it's not reachable by car and is stunningly beautiful. The walk starts from the car park (just before the turning to Droman), and it's an 8-mile round trip. The path can get very busy and is not the most exciting of routes but it is a lovely destination.

FISHING

There are a variety of loch, river and sea fishing available in the area but apart from the sea fishing you will need a permit. Visit https://www.kinlochbervie.info/durness-and-klb-angling-club. There is some information at the cottage but it may not be up to date.

MOUNTAINS

Our 'local' mountains are worth a climb on a good day - Ben Stack, Arkle and the most challenging, Foinaven, mostly because it's such a trek just to get to the bottom of it! There are plenty of websites which advise routes etc.

EATING OUT

Our cottage is in a beautiful part of the world but you don't really come here for eating out and going to the pub! Even so, there are a few options ...

The Quay House in Kinlochbervie down by the harbour has recently opened for coffee and lunches and has a lovely shop attached to it - recommended. **Loch Clash Larder** (see facebook/instagram) a van on side of the road just beyond London Stores towards Rhiconich is delicious, open April - October for fresh local seafood.

Polin Beach from the point

Oldshoremore Beach

Sandwood Bay

Arkle with Loch Stack in foreground

The **Crofter's Kitchen** in Scourie in a unit down by the bay also has a great range of fresh seafood and local venison etc, check opening times etc at https://www.crofterskitchen.com/. **The Shorehouse Seafood Restaurant**, Tarbert, Scourie IV27 4SS (call to check space and if it's open 01971 502 251), delicious and beautiful view, early sittings; **The Old Schoolhouse Restaurant**, Inshegra, IV27 4RH (phone 01971 521 383).

PLACES TO VISIT AND WALKS

Kinlochbervie is the local village, with a shop, fishing fleet and regular fish market/auction which is a must to visit - tourists are welcome to walk around the sheds and view the catch.

Handa Island (https://scottishwildlifetrust.org.uk/reserve/handa-island/) is an amazing nature reserve run by the Scottish Wildlife Trust, which provides home for over a 100,000 breeding seabirds (making it one of the largest in northern Europe), including guillemots, razorbills, kittiwakes, fulmars, puffins, shags, great skuas and Artic skuas. Seasonal access to the uninhabited island is via a ferry trip from Tarbert (where the Shorehouse restaurant is also located, see above). There is a circular, 3.5 mile walk all around the island with spectacular views all the way.

Smoo Cave (https://www.visitscotland.com/info/towns-villages/smoo-cave-p245631) – two miles east of Durness this is probably the largest cave entrance in Britain and has been a tourist attraction since Sir Walter Scott's visit in 1814. The large limestone cave is studded with stalagmites and stalactites. There are some lovely walks around the area too, and wonderful beaches.

Durness & Balnakeil Craft Village - The craft village is made up of a number of different workshops and craft shops, and an excellent chocolate shop and cafe, Cocoa Mountain - chocolate heaven! Durness has a couple of food shops, some cafes and amazing beaches.

Faraid Head walk starting at Balnakeil beach car park (near craft village) taking you across the beach and then around the headland (approx. 5 miles). Churchyard well worth a visit. Fantastic beaches and walks. Whale, dolphin and otter sightings.

Lotte Glob, renowned ceramic artist is worth a visit, wonderful ceramics and croft garden with sculptures etc, out of Durness on the road along Loch Eribol. You will need to book a visit if you wish to go, see contact page at https://lotteglob.co.uk/.

Walk Highlands website has some good walks: https://www.walkhighlands.co.uk/sutherland/

Eas a Chual Aluinn is Britain's tallest waterfall at 200m high. Its name means 'the splendid waterfall of Coul'. Boat trips may leave from Kylesku twice daily in the summer and last approximately two hours (you will need to check, seasonal).

Highland Stoneware (www.highlandstoneware.com, Tel 01571 844 376) – This extremely popular pottery is based in Lochinver and has a showroom and workshop which shoppers can walk around observing the craftspeople at work. (Again, this may need to be checked prior to visiting).

If you want to enjoy the water, **Ridgway Adventure** (https://www.ridgway-adventure.co.uk/sea-kayak-days/) organises days out on sea kayak. An excellent way to get close to the wild life.

And of course there's lots more for you to discover for yourself!

Ben Stack